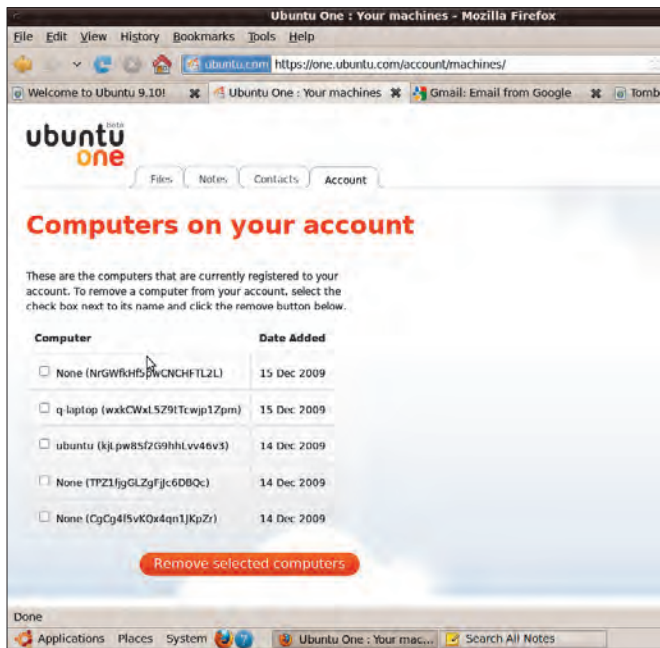




The Ubuntu One account page

graphics drivers and follow the instructions.

On the cloud

Ubuntu One is the name of Ubuntu's cloud service. The Link to Ubuntu One is under the Applications, Internet Menu. A user needs to sign up for the service first, and on first launch a browser window takes you to the sign up page. Subsequently launching Ubuntu One link opens the preferences window, where one can set the behaviour of the service. An icon in the system tray will display the status of the Cloud and allow easy synchronisation. Unfortunately, despite 9.10 being the first Ubuntu to offer this feature, the synchronisation operation is not smooth and the reason for this is that the client software is incompatible with the server.

Nonetheless, one can add data in the form of files, contacts and notes to the Ubuntu One account and these can be synchronised within applications like Nau-

tilus, Tomboy and Evolution respectively on systems running the service.

Migrating settings

Theoretically, it involves merely copying the files from one installation site to the other. Ubuntu has incorpor-

PCLinux installation as well. Even when the other OS is detected, the end result of the migration is not obvious. There doesn't seem to be any documents imported to the user's home folder, and neither are any settings changed in the Ubuntu environment as a result.

Wubi

This is an interesting utility. Briefly, it allows one to install Ubuntu in any Windows partition. Wubi creates a folder in the Windows partition where all OS files are stored, and requires atleast 3 GB free space to start.

After providing a password, space and location to store the files at the start of the process, there is no user interaction required. So, potential mine-fields like creating partitions are avoided. Once launched, Wubi goes through the same motions as the normal installation process. On rebooting, post installation, the modified

using a non native file system. The application can be uninstalled like any Windows program and the disk space freed, but the boot menu is not restored (atleast in Windows XP). If no entry to the uninstall link figures in any menu, the uninstall file is present in the Ubuntu folder. Wubi is highly recommended for people using Windows and should be the only way to try Ubuntu to avoid most troubles of a normal installation. Sadly, Linux users are not similarly treated.

Mobile broadband

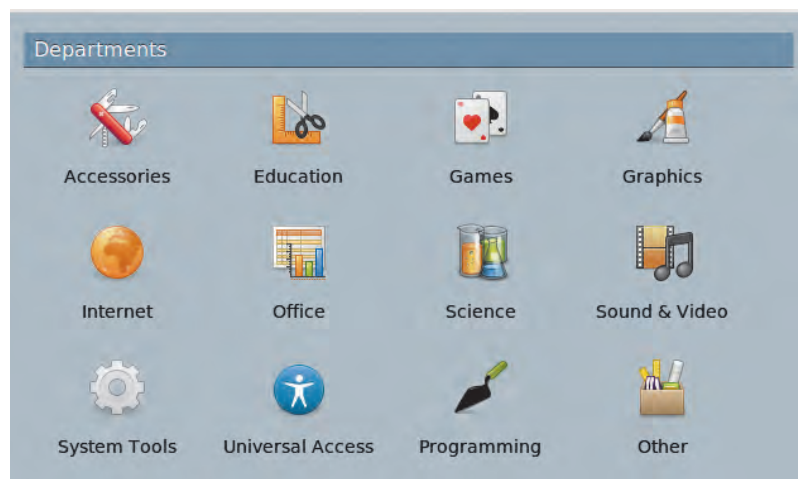
One feature that thoroughly impressed this writer was the automatic configuration of the GPRS enabled mobile phone. Just plugging in the mobile presented a wizard, which already had the settings to access various GPRS service providers from India, like BSNL, Airtel, Idea etc. A few clicks and one was online. Impressive. In contrast with the earlier PPP

or wvdial routine in older versions of Linux, and the Nokia PC Suite in Windows, 9.10 truly is in a different league.

Conclusion

9.10 is for the inveterate distro hopper who already has gotten into the Ubuntu groove. For Windows users, Wubi is the recommended route - probably the best

way to sample a distro, something for the other distros to emulate. For the rest of us, 9.10 is worth a dekho to drool over the visual effects, and return to our more familiar distros.



The Ubuntu Software Center

tated a tool to do this during the installation, but in the three installations that this writer did, the tool failed to detect the Windows installation on the same disk, and in one case the

boot menu presents both OS options with the default option being the Windows installation. The Ubuntu installation performs quite smoothly with no apparent lag inspite of